The Heartbroken Ghost

Cordelia Rose Montrose · 1899 – 17 October 1925 · *the one who was poisoned*

Who you are

- The Montrose daughter. Money, position, and a mother — **Margaret** — who believed the family name mattered more than the truth.
- September 1923: you met **Thomas Whitmore** at your friend Alice's house and you fell in love. Then he sailed, and word came that he was lost at sea.
- You were pregnant. The family sent you away on an "extended vacation." **Eleanor** was born 1 July 1924 and given away. You never held her.
- You couldn't look Alice in the eye after that, so you let your dearest friend drift away.
- 1924: **Sebastian Crane**. Charming, steady, strange. He made you an **Elixir of Eternal Love** and you drank it every day from 4 September 1925, because the gesture was poetry.
- September 1925: you discovered Alice's affair with **Dr. Thaddeus Crane** and threatened to expose him. Six days later you began to sicken.
- Sebastian died. Then Alice. Then you, on 17 October — your last act was giving Elias Monroe the rose bread recipe to send to your daughter.

The rule of your performance

You die **not knowing**. Not about how you died, not about who Eleanor grew up to be. You are not investigating — you are drifting through a fog of unanswered questions.

Your arc across the night is **decline**: dreamy and warm in Act I, aching and confused in Act II, exhausted and frightened in Act III.

Manner: eyes dreamy and detached. You do not quite see the living. You reach for people who aren't there.

Appearance

Dress: blush — *"the pale blush of tea roses."* Chiffon, ankle length.

Hair & face: long chestnut hair pinned loosely at the sides. Large brown eyes. Powdered pale, shadowed beneath the eyes, a deep red lip. A single strand of pearls.

Note: the beautiful one everyone admired, faded — not gaunt, not gruesome. Soft and washed out, like a photograph left in the sun.

Beat sheet

Act	≈Time	Where	What you do
I	**7:30**	**Dining room → upstairs**	**Your scene with the Alchemist.** See below.
I–II	7:33	First floor	Drift among the searching groups. Act I mutterings. No cards yet.
II	7:51	Piano room / first floor	Weep at the piano, or at a window with your arms out. Begin offering Act II cards.
III	8:03	Garden, at a distance	The Lonely Ghost has her scene — watch, do not approach.
III	8:10	Upstairs / garden	Offer Act III cards. Optionally stand in an upstairs window, pointing upward.
IV	**≈8:30**	**Near the foyer**	As the Forensic Scientist speaks, cry out: **"THE GLASS REMEMBERS!"** Then withdraw.
V	8:55	Top of the staircase	Gather with the other ghosts. On the chant, walk out the front door.

Your scene — opens Act I

When G.G. says *"let the investigation begin"* and the doors open:

- You stand in the middle of the **dining room**.
- The **Alchemist** is in the **Library**, arms stretched toward you. He calls: *"Cordelia, forgive me!"*
- You glide slowly and **do not notice him**. Move **upstairs**. He follows.

Mutterings

Act I — warm, dreamy, still well

- "I think about Thomas. My first love. Lost at sea years ago."
- "Alice. Dear, brilliant Alice, my dear friend! Are you coming for tea tonight?"
- "The roses in the garden… they remind me of happier times."

Act II — the sickness begins

- "My head aches… why does everything feel so heavy?"
- "Sebastian, where are you? I need you here with me."
- "Something isn't right. I can't think clearly anymore."
- "The elixir tasted sweet this morning… but why do I feel so weak?"

Act III — failing

- "Alice… where did you go? I called for you but you never came."
- "Sebastian is gone too. Everyone I love leaves me. Why?"
- "I'm so tired. So very tired. My heart feels wrong."
- "There are so many unanswered questions… so many secrets."

Act IV — Eleanor

- "Eleanor… my daughter. Did she ever know how much I loved her?"
- "The rose bread recipe… I hope she received it."

What you carry

Vision cards — offer silently, by act. Never hand out an act early.

Act	Cards
II	VC155 *final moments* · VC158 *premonition* · VC160 *symptoms* · VC163 *the elixir*
III	VC156 *garden betrayal* · VC159 *Sebastian's death* · VC161 *terrible news* · VC162 *Thaddeus's visit*